Chapter-wise Detailed Notes — Urban Local Bodies

Indian Government & Politics · Unit 5 · Chapter Urban Local Bodies

Assam University · BA FYUGP / NEP 2020 · Semester 1

Chapter Study Notes

Learning focus

The 74th Constitutional Amendment established the constitutional framework for municipalities in Part IXA and the Twelfth Schedule.

1. Municipal categories include Nagar Panchayats, Municipal Councils and Municipal Corporations, with classification governed by constitutional and state-law criteria.

2. Urban local bodies handle local services and planning, with responsibilities varying by state law and institutional arrangements.

3. Urban governance challenges include rapid population growth, infrastructure gaps, financial dependence, overlapping agencies and uneven service delivery.

4. Accountability can be strengthened through elected representation, transparent budgets, citizen participation, effective municipal staff and clear division of responsibilities.

Revision checklist

■ Can I define the key concept in my own words?

■ Can I explain its main features and distinguish it from related concepts?

■ Can I support an argument with a relevant example, thinker or constitutional provision?

■ Can I discuss at least one limitation or counterargument?